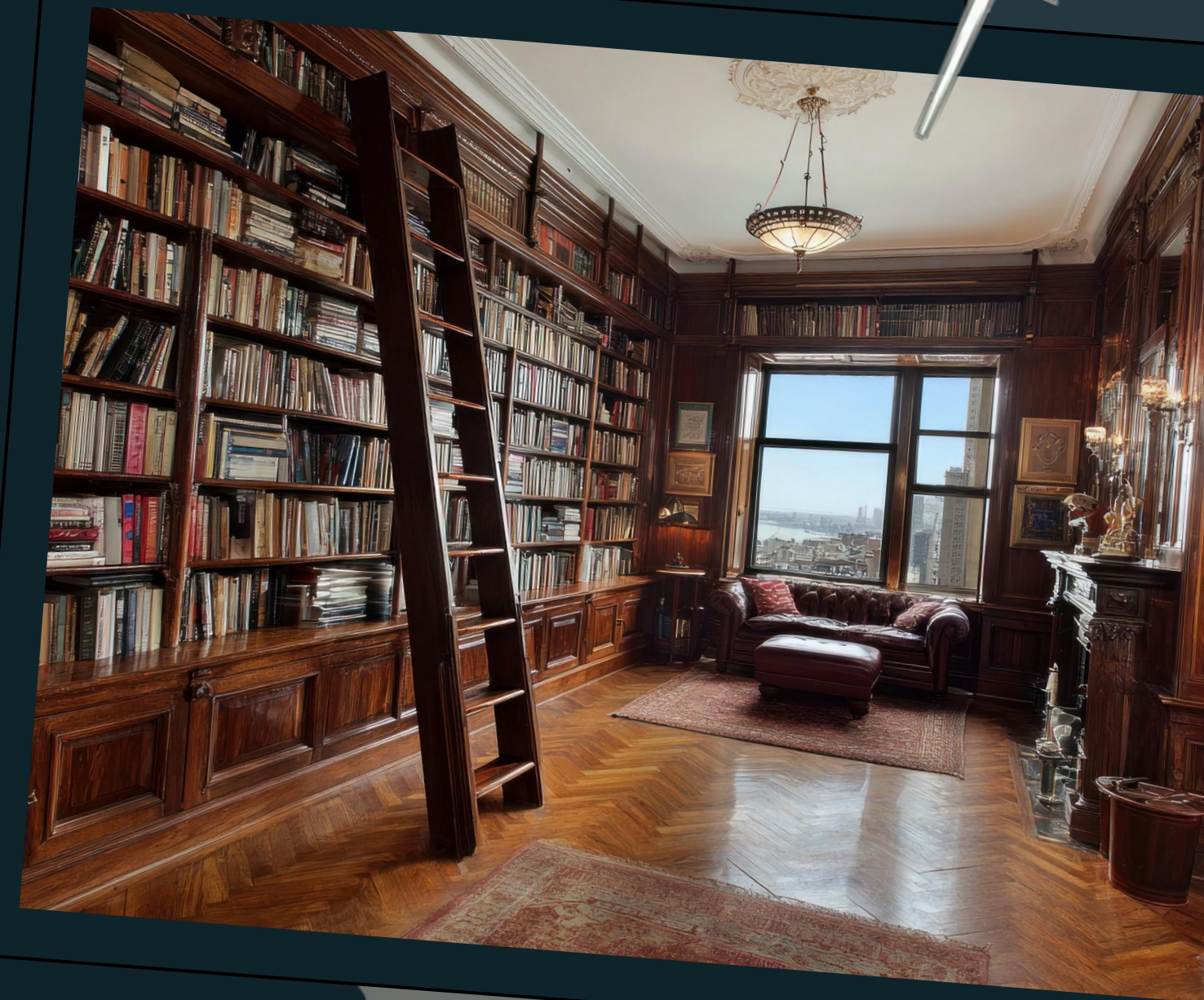


The Case Against Genrefication

Why genre-based categorization builds barriers
instead of breaking them.



Understanding Genrefication: Intent vs. Reality

The goal of genrefication is to make it easier for readers to find books by grouping them into familiar genres (Genrefication defined, n.d.). This can backfire by creating unexpected “hurdles” to discovery. Instead of opening up the library, it can limit someone's exposure to new ideas and authors (Cornwall, 2018), undermining the library's mission to promote equity, intellectual freedom, and exploration (Lechtenberg, 2018).



Genre labels reduce books to a simple category.

Flaws of Genrefication

Genre labels prevent students from discovering books that blend categories or aren't easily classified (Lechtenberg, 2018).

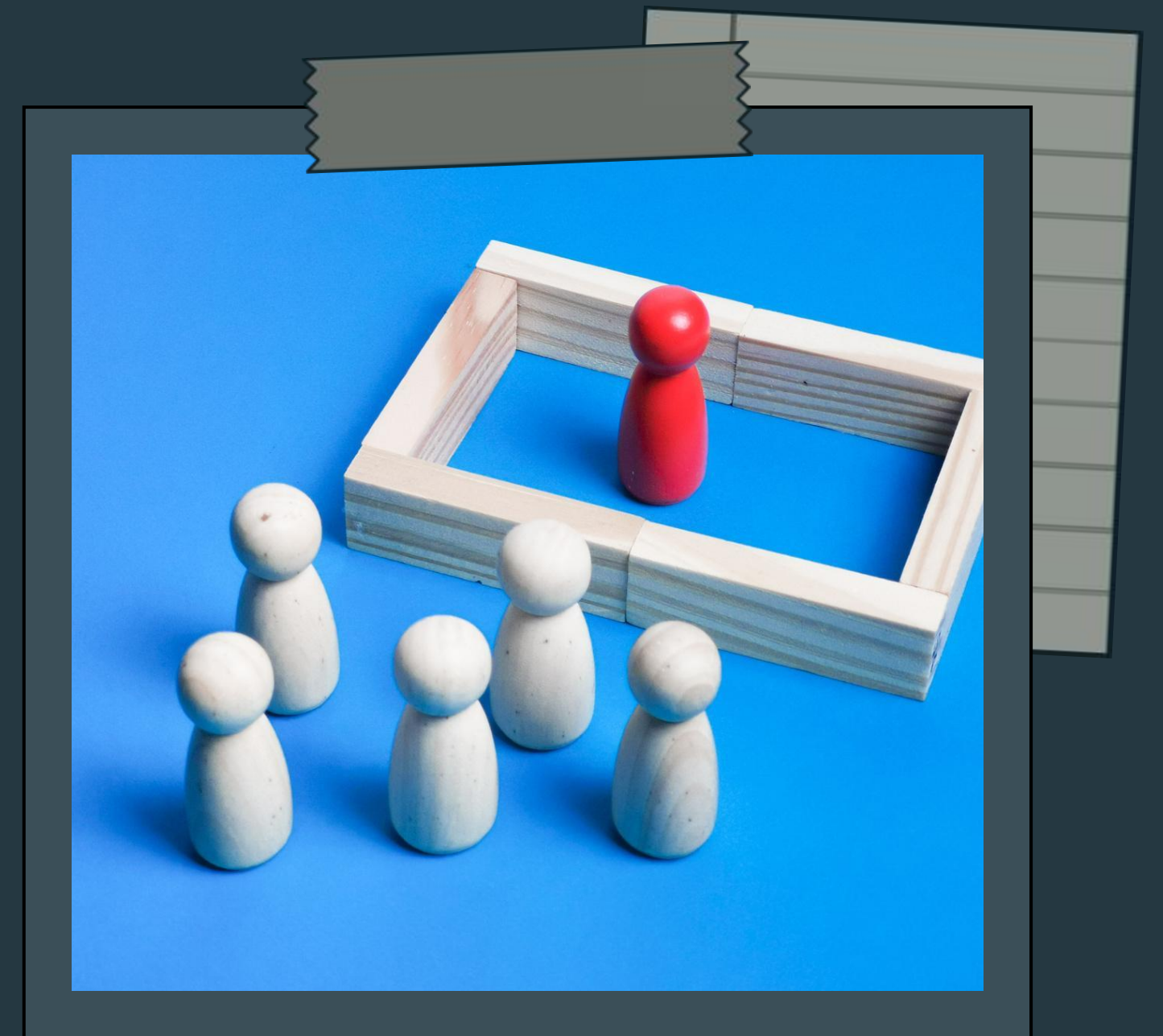
This system may end up creating bias and make it harder to find books from different perspectives or those that challenge conventional labels (Lechtenberg, 2018).

By making it too easy to find only what you're already looking for, genrefication would stop people from browsing and stumbling into something they find interesting. (Cornwall, 2018).

Students don't learn the critical research skills they'll need for academic and public libraries that use standard classification systems (Hincks, n.d.).

Limiting Access and Freedom

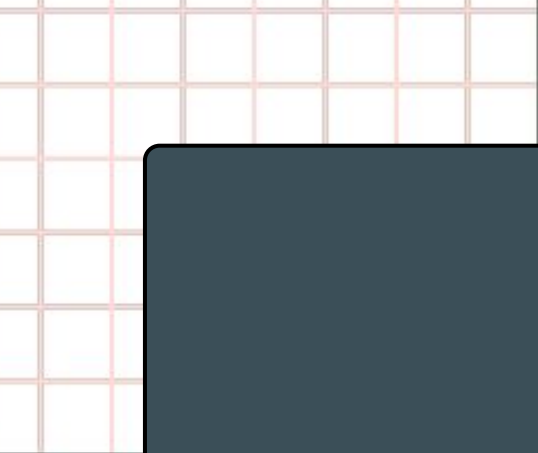
When books are sorted into strict categories, readers will stick to what they know and miss out on diverse texts. This can create a reading "echo chamber." It could end up reinforcing personal biases and restrict intellectual freedom (Lechtenberg, 2018). A library's mission is to expand a student's perspective, but genrefication can shrink it by limiting opportunities for true exploration and discovery (Lechtenberg, 2018).





Undermining True Information Literacy

Genrefication organizes the library like a bookstore. It doesn't teach the transferable skills students need during their higher education and even the real world. This hurts the development of their information literacy and leaves them unprepared for future academic challenges. Instead of learning how to navigate standard library systems, they learn a method they will never use again (Hincks, n.d.).



Logistical Problems

Workload Issues

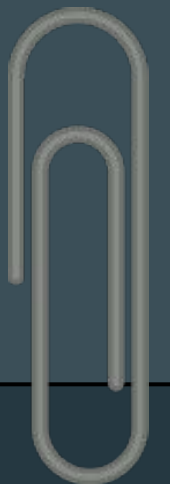
Implementing genrefication places a large burden on library staff. It would require a massive overhaul and constant updates (Arenz, 2024).

Scalability Problems

Genrefication struggles with scalability. It is very difficult to categorize a growing number of diverse materials effectively (Cornwall, 2018; Arenz, 2024).

Subjectivity in Categorization

Deciding a book's "correct" genre is often a matter of opinion. Genrefication will lead to inconsistencies and confusion since different librarians might categorize the exact same book in completely different ways.



Enhancing Dewey Decimal System

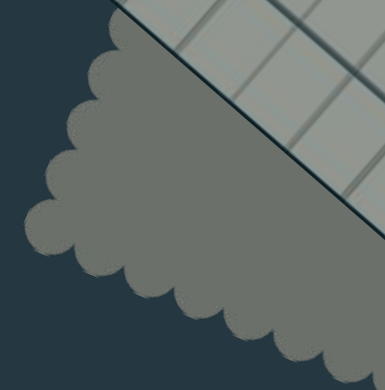
Instead of replacing the traditional Dewey Decimal System, libraries can use technology and design an interface that makes it easier to find a book. Tools like online catalogs would allow people to search for materials more efficiently. Also, better signs can guide users to the sections they are searching for (Arenz, 2024). Curated displays can give more attention to a diverse range of genres while helping people explore different genres they might not usually engage with (Lechtenberg, 2018). This way offers a better experience for learners as well as keeping the integrity of the Dewey Decimal System in tact.





The library's purpose is to prepare students for a lifetime of learning. We should adapt to the times rather than completely switch over to a new system.

We should:

- **Protect Intellectual Freedom:** Guarantee students have access to the widest possible range of ideas and perspectives (Lechtenberg, 2018).
 - **Teach Essential Skills:** Equip students with real-world research abilities that will help them in college and their future careers (Hincks, n.d.).
 - **Create a Better Experience:** Use modern tools like digital catalogs and easy to find displays to make the library more engaging and user-friendly.
 - **Rely on a Proven System:** Maintain a logical, scalable, and objective system that grows with the collection without creating logistical nightmares.
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**Thank you for your
attention!**